

BELGIUM

Model UN Research Dossier – Belgium

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Kingdom of Belgium (Royaume de Belgique / Koninkrijk België / Königreich Belgien)
Short Form	Belgium
Capital	Brussels
Region (UN)	Western European and Other States
Government Type	Federal parliamentary constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Philippe
Head of Government	Prime Minister Bart De Wever (as of March 2025)
Currency	Euro (EUR)
UN Member Since	27 December 1945
MUN Standing	Active participant in peacekeeping and human rights initiatives; member of various UN bodies; advocates for multilateralism and international law.

General Book Recommendations

1. **"The Politics of Belgium"** – Marleen Brans
2. **"A Concise History of Belgium"** – Guy Vanthemsche
3. **"Belgium and Poland in International Relations 1830–1831"** – J.A. Betley
4. **"Boosting Skills for Greener Jobs in Flanders, Belgium"** – OECD Green Growth Studies

5. "The United Nations: How it Works and What it Does" – David J. Whittaker

Belgium & UNCSW: Verified Resource Table

Resource Title	Link	Description
Belgium's Step It Up Commitment Text	PDF	Outlines Belgium's 25 commitments to gender equality and women's empowerment as part of the UN Women "Step It Up" initiative.
Belgium's Commitments to Gender Equality	UN Women	Details Belgium's comprehensive commitments covering both external and internal policies to promote gender equality.
Belgium and UN Women Sign Agreement	UN Women News	Highlights the partnership between Belgium and UN Women to promote women's rights and gender equality.
Belgium's Intervention at the 68th CSW Session	PDF	Belgium's official statement at the 68th session of UNCSW, addressing various aspects of gender equality and women's rights.
UNCSW69 Concludes with Renewed Commitments	European Commission	Summarizes the outcomes of the 69th session of UNCSW, including Belgium's participation and commitments.
Experts of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women Commend Belgium	UN Geneva	Highlights Belgium's progress in legislation and addresses questions on gender-based violence and women's participation in decision-making.
Commission on the Status of Women Overview	UN Women	Provides information on the CSW's role in promoting gender equality and the empowerment of women globally.
CSW68 Overview	UN Women	Details the 68th session of the CSW, including themes and key messages relevant to Belgium's commitments.
CSW69 Media Advisory	UN Women	Provides information on the 69th session of the CSW, including events

		and discussions pertinent to Belgium.
Calendar of Side Events at CSW61	<u>UN Women</u>	Lists side events during the 61st session of the CSW, including those involving Belgium.
Outcomes of the Commission on the Status of Women	<u>UN Women</u>	Summarizes the outcomes and agreed conclusions from various sessions of the CSW, providing context for Belgium's involvement.
Commission on the Status of Women Meeting Summary	<u>UN Press</u>	Provides a summary of the CSW meeting, including themes such as poverty, environment, and natural disasters, relevant to Belgium's interests.
Belgium's Country Fact Sheet – UN Women Data Hub	<u>UN Women Data</u>	Offers statistical data on gender equality indicators in Belgium, supporting its CSW commitments.

Unique Aspects of Belgium's Engagement with UNCSW and Gender Equality

- **Constitutional Guarantee:** Since 2002, Belgium's Constitution has made a clear promise to uphold gender equality, showcasing the country's dedication to this principle at the highest legal level.
- **Gender Budgeting:** Belgium has taken a significant step by adopting gender-responsive budgeting, which means they're weaving gender considerations into every aspect of federal policies and budget planning.
- **High Representation of Women in Parliament:** Recent data shows that women now occupy a notable share of seats in the Belgian parliament, highlighting the strides made towards achieving political gender equality.
- **Comprehensive Commitments:** Belgium has pledged 25 commitments aimed at enhancing gender equality and empowering women, addressing both external and internal policies.
- **Partnership with UN Women:** Belgium has teamed up with UN Women, signing agreements to champion women's rights and push for gender equality

around the world.

- **Active Participation in UNCSW Sessions:** Belgium is a regular participant in UNCSW sessions, actively submitting national reviews and ensuring its policies are in sync with global gender equality goals.
 - **Focus on Preventing Sexual Harassment:** Belgium has put laws in place to support gender equality and is making a concerted effort to tackle sexual harassment and abuse against women.
 - **Support for Women's Political Participation:** Belgium is pushing for more support for women in politics, making sure that all women have a seat at the table when it comes to decision-making processes.
 - **Integration of Gender Perspectives in Foreign Policy:** Belgium is committed to weaving gender equality goals into its foreign policy and development cooperation efforts.
 - **Promotion of Women's Rights through Civil Society:** Civil society organizations in Belgium are crucial in championing women's rights and promoting gender equality.
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Diplomatie